jssrepl Install and first run

This guide tells you how to have a working `jssrepl` on Linux and Windows.

1. Requirements

Item	Requirement
JDK	GraalVM Community JDK (https://www.graalvm.org/downloads/), minimum version **graalvm-community-21.0.4.1.1+11.1**
Files	Files and folders in directory `jssrc\src\org\jssrepl`
Disk space	About 550 MB for the JDK, plus a few MB for jssrepl

Note. *jssrepl needs GraalVM JDK 21*graalvm-community-21.0.4.1.1+11.1 or newer, so older JDKs will not work. To run jssrepl, you also may use other JDK than GraalVM, like https://adoptium.net/ JDK 25.

2. Install GraalVM JDK 25

Download GraalVM Community from the official pages:

- Download page: https://www.graalvm.org/downloads/
- All releases: https://github.com/graalvm/graalvm-ce-builds/releases

Choose the build for your operating system and CPU architecture, version **21.0.4.1.1+11 or newer**. The exact file names depend on the release, so check the asset list on the release page.

Linux

1. Extract the JDK archive into a folder of your choice, for example `~/opt`:

```
mkdir -p ~/opt
tar -xzf graalvm-community-jdk-*_linux-x64_bin.tar.gz -C ~/opt
```

Use the file you downloaded. The name above is an example, and ARM machines use an `aarch64` build. We don't have ARM, please report if you do.

2. Find the extracted folder name and set `JAVA_HOME`. Add these lines to `~/.bashrc` (or `~/.zshrc`), replacing the folder name with the one you actually got:

```
export JAVA_HOME="$HOME/opt/graalvm-community-openjdk-21.0.4+9.0"
export PATH="$JAVA_HOME/bin:$PATH"
```

3. Load the new settings:

```
source ~/.bashrc
```

Windows

1. Extract the downloaded JDK `.zip` file, for example to `C:\Java`. You should end up with a folder like `C:\Java\graalvm-community-openjdk-25.0.1`.
2. Open **Start**, search for **Environment Variables**, and choose **Edit environment variables for your account**.
3. Create a new user variable (if you are not able to do this, see the note below):

Name	Value
`JAVA_HOME`	`C:\Java\graalvm-community-openjdk-25.0.1` (your actual folder)

4. Edit the user variable `Path` and add a new entry: `%JAVA_HOME%\bin`
5. Click OK on all dialogs, then **open a new terminal** so the changes take effect.

Verify the JDK

Run this in a new terminal:

```
java -version
```

The output must mention **GraalVM** and version **25**. If it shows another Java version, your `Path` is picking up a different JDK. Make sure `%JAVA_HOME%\bin` (Linux/macOS: `$JAVA_HOME/bin`) comes first in `Path`.

Note. Windows: We have seen some companies block editing the environment variables, if so, after next step, rename folder from graalvm-community-25.0.1 to graalvm-jdk25, keeping path names simple, so you will have:

C:\bigstorage\jdk25

C:\Java (use launcher `java.exe` in it)

- java *
  - bin
- C:\Apps\jssrepl\jdk25\bin\java *

3. Install jssrepl.jar and its libraries

jssrepl layout:

```
jssrepl\                    
  jssrepl.jar               Library jars, such as JDBC Java libraries
  scripts\                  Your scripts, to keep them organized in a folder :)
  jssrepl.jar               The compiled REPL
  jssrepl.sh                Linux launcher (section 4)
  jssrepl.bat               Windows launcher (section 4)
```

Extract the REPL engine and scripts\jssrepl folders, from folder jssrepl\www\scripts\jssrepl to folder $HOME/Apps on Linux or C:\Apps on Windows.

You must have folders $HOME/Apps/jssrepl or C:\Apps\jssrepl

4. Start the jssrepl

Linux, Open a terminal window in $HOME/Apps/jssrepl, and run: `./jssrepl.sh`

Windows, Open a terminal window in C:\Apps\jssrepl, and run: `jssrepl.bat`

The launcher starts java with the right options and classpath.

Option	Purpose
`--enable-native-access=ALL-UNNAMED`	Allows JLine and GraalVM to use native access without warnings
`--sun-misc-unsafe-memory-access=allow`	Allows libraries that still use `sun.misc.Unsafe` memory access on newer JDKs
`-XX:+UseParallelGC`	Picks the "throughput only" performance warning
`-Dorg.graalvm.language.maintainconfig=false`	Puts the shell and all libraries on the classpath
`-cp "jssrepl.jar;lib\*;scripts"`	The main class
`jssrepl.Main`	

5. Work with the interactive shell

After starting the REPL, you should see the banner and the `jss` prompt.

```
/.../jssrepl> jssrepl.sh
The parameter is a directory, maybe jssrepl home? /home/jon/Apps/jssrepl
To run a jss file do: load <path to jss file>
jss - GraalVM JavaScript Polyglot Context Interactive Shell
Type JavaScript to evaluate it, or :help for commands.
Use :paste for multi-line input, then :end to run it.
To see parameters when you run jssrepl, type:parameters, it is a JavaScript array you can use.
jssrepl home directory is stored in parameters array.
jss>

...
jss>
jss> parameters
[
  "/home/jon/Apps/jssrepl"
]
jss> quit
```

`parameters[0]` shows the folder that contains `jssrepl.jar`, which confirms the launcher is using the right jar.

6. Loading a library file from your jssrepl

Using a text editor, create file `hello.jss` save it to your jssrepl\scripts folder, load it and call the function `helloThatYourName()`

```
function helloName( ) { return "Hello, " + name + "!" }
```

Start your jssrepl and load your `hello.jss` :

```
jss> load(parameters[0] + "/scripts/hello.jss")
...
jss> helloThatYourName()
"Hello, YourName!"
```

There are some scripts you can use, load the script and call the function:

```
jss> load(parameters[0] + "/scripts/helloWorld.jss")
Call The Function, type:helloWorld()
jss> helloWorld()
"Hello World!!"
jss>


jss> load(parameters[0] + "/scripts/cs_to_json.jss")
Call The Function, type:CSV_to_JSON()
jss> CSV_to_JSON()
Error: ["error":"Cannot read CSV file","message":"java.io.FileNotFoundException: /home/jon/Apps/jssrepl/data/sample.csv (No such file or directory)"]
jss>
```

*** When errors like this happen, just fix it in your files and reload the script, this case we fixed, the config.ini, from data to scripts/data, and reload the script.

```
jss> load(parameters[0] + "/scripts/cs_to_json.jss")
Call The Function, type:CSV_to_JSON()
jss> CSV_to_JSON()
[
  {
    "data": {
      "name": "Alice",
      "age": "30",
      "city": "London"
    },
    {
      "name": "Bob",
      "age": "25",
      "city": "Paris"
    },
    {
      "name": "Charlie",
      "age": "35",
      "city": "Berlin"
    }
  }
]
jss>
```

Script to read a csv using *JDBC*:

```
jss> load(parameters[0] + "/scripts/csvreader_jdbc.jss")
Call the function(s) for scripts/data
Name;Age;City
Alice;30;New York
Bob;25;London
Charlie;35;Tokyo
```

Script to get the weather:

```
jss> load(parameters[0] + "/scripts/getweather.jss")
Response Status: 200
{
  "location": {
    "name": "Moor Side",
    "region": "Lincolnshire",
    "country": "United Kingdom",
    "lat": 53.03,
    "lon": -0.14,
    "tz_id": "Europe/London",
    "localtime_epoch": 1759261496,
    "localtime": "2025-11-08 22:31"
  },
  "current": {
    "last_updated_epoch": 1759261496,
    "last_updated": "2025-11-08 22:30",
    "temp_c": 10.6,
    "temp_f": 51.1,
    "is_day": 0,
    "condition": {
      "text": "Clear",
      "icon": "//cdn.weatherapi.com/weather/64x64/night/113.png",
      "code": 1000
    },
    "wind_mph": 14.3,
    "wind_kph": 23.0,
    "wind_degree": 81,
    "wind_dir": "E",
    "pressure_mb": 1031,
    "pressure_in": 30.45,
    "precip_mm": 0.0,
    "precip_in": 0.0,
    "humidity": 86,
    "cloud": 0,
    "feelslike_c": 6.7,
    "feelslike_f": 44.1,
    "windchill_c": 7.6,
    "windchill_f": 45.6,
    "heatindex_c": 10.6,
    "heatindex_f": 51.2,
    "dewpoint_c": 8.5,
    "dewpoint_f": 47.3,
    "vis_km": 10,
    "vis_miles": 6,
    "uv": 0.0,
    "gust_mph": 23.5,
    "gust_kph": 37.8,
    "will_it_rain": 0,
    "chance_of_rain": 15,
    "will_it_snow": 0,
    "chance_of_snow": 0,
    "air_quality": {
      "us-epa-index": 1
    }
  }
}
```

6. Troubleshooting

Problem	Cause and fix
`java: command not found` or `'java' is not recognized`	`java_HOME` or `PATH` is not set, or you did not open a new terminal. Redo section 2.
`java -version` does not mention GraalVM or shows an version below 25	Another JDK is first in `PATH`. Move `$JAVA_HOME/bin` (Linux) or `%JAVA_HOME%\bin` (Windows) to the front.
`UnsupportedClassVersionError`	The JDK running jssrepl is older than the one that built it. Use GraalVM JDK 25 or newer.
`jssrepl.jar is not found` at `...`	`jssrepl.jar` is not where `jssrepl.sh` / `jssrepl.bat` looks. Run it from the folder that contains `jssrepl.jar`, or edit the `JSSREPL_JAR` / `set JAR=` line.
`Error: Could not find or load main class jssrepl`	The `jssrepl.jar` folder is missing or incomplete. Copy the full folder next to `jssrepl.jar`.
`NoClassDefFoundError: org/graalvm/polyglot/...` or `org/jline/...`	The GraalVM jars are missing from `jssrepl\lib`. Rebuild the library folder using `MyClasspath.ps1` section 3.
`WARNING: A restricted method ... has been called`	The `--enable-native-access=ALL-UNNAMED` option is missing from your launcher. Use the scripts in section 4 exactly.
Arrow keys print `^[[A` instead of recalling history	The terminal is not detected as a real terminal. Run jssrepl from a normal terminal window, not from a redirected or piped shell. On Windows, use Windows Terminal or PowerShell.
`Permission denied` when running `jssrepl.sh`	Run: `chmod +x ~/Apps/jssrepl/jssrepl.sh`
`jssrepl: command not found` (Linux)	`~/.local/bin` is not in `PATH`, or you did not run `source ~/.bashrc`.
`'jssrepl' is not recognized` (Windows)	The jssrepl folder is not in `Path`, or the terminal was opened before you changed it. Open a new terminal.